

ACTIVITY:

React or Respond?

 **Objective:** Match each workplace situation with the most thoughtful response from the Phrase Bank

For each match, decide:

- Is the tone reactive or regulated?
- Is the response direct or softened?
- What format is this best suited for (in person, email, or message)?

Instructions

1. Read the workplace situations below.
2. Match each one with the best response from the Phrase Bank.
3. For each match, decide:
 - Is the tone reactive or regulated?
 - Is it direct or softened?
 - What format fits best (in person, email, or text/message)?
4. Optional: Rewrite the phrase using your own natural speaking or writing style.

PHRASE BANK: Use each phrase once

- A. "I'd like to clarify something before we move forward. Can we walk through your concern?"
- B. "I want to give this the right attention. I'll review it carefully and respond tomorrow."
- C. "I'm feeling a bit caught off guard. Can I take a moment to gather my thoughts?"
- D. "It would help me if we could let each other finish before responding."
- E. "This feels urgent. Can we confirm what's most important right now so I can prioritize?"

MATCH THE PHRASE TO THE SITUATION

Workplace Situations

1. During a team meeting, a colleague publicly questions the quality of your work and suggests it may delay the project. You feel defensive and surprised.

Phrase Bank choice:

☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D ☐ E

Is the tone

☐ Reactive ☐ Regulated

Is it:

What format is this?

☐ Direct ☐ Softened

☐ In person ☐ Email ☐ Text/Message

Rewrite the phrase using your own natural speaking or writing style.

2. You receive a detailed critique of your proposal in an email at 9:30 PM. You are tired and feel misunderstood.

Phrase Bank choice:

☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D ☐ E

Is the tone

☐ Reactive ☐ Regulated

Is it:

What format is this?

☐ Direct ☐ Softened

☐ In person ☐ Email ☐ Text/Message

Rewrite the phrase using your own natural speaking or writing style.

MATCH THE PHRASE TO THE SITUATION

Workplace Situations

3. Your manager changes the deadline unexpectedly and says, "We need this done ASAP." You're already managing multiple priorities and feel overwhelmed.

Phrase Bank choice:

☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D ☐ E

Is the tone

☐ Reactive ☐ Regulated

Is it:

☐ Direct ☐ Softened

What format is this?

☐ In person ☐ Email ☐ Text/Message

Rewrite the phrase using your own natural speaking or writing style.

4. A teammate interrupts you several times while you're explaining an idea, cutting you off before you finish your point.

Phrase Bank choice:

☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D ☐ E

Is the tone

☐ Reactive ☐ Regulated

Is it:

☐ Direct ☐ Softened

What format is this?

☐ In person ☐ Email ☐ Text/Message

Rewrite the phrase using your own natural speaking or writing style.

MATCH THE PHRASE TO THE SITUATION

Workplace Situations

5. In a discussion about a new process, someone raises a concern but speaks vaguely. You're unsure what the real issue is and sense tension in the room.

Phrase Bank choice:

☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D ☐ E

Is the tone

☐ Reactive ☐ Regulated

Is it:

What format is this?

☐ Direct ☐ Softened

☐ In person ☐ Email ☐ Text/Message

Rewrite the phrase using your own natural speaking or writing style.

MATCH THE PHRASE TO THE SITUATION

Workplace Situations Answer Key

Situation	Phrase	Tone	Direct or Softened	Format
1	C	Regulated	Softened	In Person
2	B	Regulated	Direct	Email
3	E	Regulated	Direct	In Person
4	D	Regulated	Softened	In Person
5	A	Regulated	Direct	In Person